

Microsoft to abandon X-Series Android smartphones too

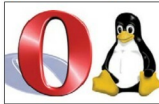
It hasn't been long since Microsoft ventured into the Android market with its X series devices and the company has already revealed plans to abandon the series. With the announcement of up to 18,000 job cuts, the company is also phasing out its feature phones and recently launched Nokia X Android smartphones.

Here are excerpts of an internal email sent by Jo Harlow, who heads the phone business under Microsoft devices, to Microsoft employees: "Placing Mobile Phone services in maintenance mode: With the clear focus on Windows Phones, all Mobile Phones-related services and enablers are planned to move into maintenance mode; effective: immediately. This means there will be no new features or updates to services on any Mobile Phones platform as a result of these plans. We plan to consider strategic options for Xpress Browser to enable continuation of the service outside of Microsoft. We are committed to supporting our existing customers, and will ensure proper operation during the controlled shutdown of services over the next 18 months. A detailed plan and timeline for each service will be communicated over the coming weeks.

"Transitioning developer efforts and investments: We plan to transition developer efforts and investments to focus on the Windows ecosystem while improving the company's financial performance. To focus on the growing momentum behind Windows Phone, we plan to immediately begin ramping down developer engagement activities related to Nokia X, Asha and Series 40 apps, and shift support to maintenance mode."

that the company's streaming stick will come with open source technology, which will help developers to develop HDTV streaming apps for smartphones.

Opera is once again available on Linux



Australian Web browser company, Opera, has finally released a beta version for its Linux OS. This Opera 24 version for Linux has the same features as Opera 24 on the Windows and Mac platforms. Chrome and Firefox are currently the two most used browsers on the Linux platform. Opera 24 will be a good alternative to them.

As of now, only the developer or beta version of Opera for Linux is available. We are hoping to see a stable version in the near future. In this beta version, Linux users will get to experience popular Opera features like Speed Dial, Discover, Stash, etc. Speed Dial is a home page that gives users an overview of their history, folders and bookmarks. Discover is an RSS reader, embedded within the browser. Gathering and reading articles of interest would be more authentic with the Discover feature. Stash is like Pinterest, within a browser. Its UI is inspired from Pinterest. It allows users to collect websites and categorise them. Stash is designed to enable users to plan their travel, work and personal lives with a collection of links.

Unlock your Moto X with your tattoo



Motorola is implementing an alternative security system for Moto X. It is frustrating to remember difficult passwords while simpler passwords are easy to crack. To counter this, VivaLnk has launched digital tattoos. This tattoo will automatically unlock the Moto X when applied to the skin.

This technology is based on Near Field Communication to connect with smartphones and authenticate access. Motorola is working on optimising digital tattoos with Google's Advance Technology and Projects.

The pricing is on the higher side but this is a great initiative in wearable technology. Developing user friendly alternatives to the password and PIN number has been a major focus of tech companies. Motorola had talked about this in the introductory session of the D11 conference at California this May, when it discussed the idea of passwords in pills or tattoos. The idea may seem like a gimmick, but you never know when it will become commonly used. VivaLnk is working on making this technology compatible with other smartphones too. It is considering entering the domain of creating tattoos of different types and designs.

OpenSSL flaws fixed by PHP

PHP recently pushed out new versions for its popular scripting language, which fix many crucial bugs and, out of those, two are of OpenSSL. The flaws are not serious like Heartbleed, which popped up a couple of months back. One flaw is directly related to OpenSSL handling time stamps and the other is related to the same thing in a different way. PHP 5.5.14 and 5.4.30 have fixed both flaws.